

Listening: details, opinions and implications

Component 2 · all five exercise types · 20-mark practice set | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Predict answer types, follow corrections and compare distractors. Ask a teacher or partner to read the original scripts twice without showing them first.

Listen for a corrected plan

Before playback, compare options and predict whether you need a place, time, action or opinion. The correct answer may come after a speaker changes plans. On the second hearing, verify your first choice; do not select the first familiar word.

Worked example

"I wanted the train, but it was cancelled, so I cycled" → bicycle, not train.

Follow attitudes and implied meaning

Distinguish "I thought it would be difficult" from "it was difficult"; a speaker can revise an opinion. For matching, identify each speaker's defining reason before choosing a statement. The official Component 2 has 40 one-mark questions over five exercises; this 20-item subset samples all five types.

Worked example

"I was nervous, although in the end the audience helped me relax" signals a change in attitude.

Practice paper

Listening: details, opinions and implications

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Administration

The teacher or partner reads each numbered script in the teacher section at a natural pace twice, with a short pause between readings. The student should not look ahead at scripts or answers. This is a 20-item subset spanning all five exercise types; the full Cambridge listening component has 40 marks.

Exercise 1 · Short extracts · visual-style choice cards

1. How did the speaker travel? [1]

A Bus	B Bicycle	C Train	D Car
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Answer: _____

2. When is the appointment? [1]

A Friday 10:00	B Friday 10:30	C Saturday 10:00	D Saturday 10:30
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Answer: _____

3. What should the listener bring? [1]

A Laptop	B Paper	C Notebook	D Camera
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Answer: _____

4. Where will the friends meet? [1]

A Library	B Museum	C Café	D Sports centre
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Answer: _____

Exercise 2 · Two short extracts, two questions each

5. Which day did the speaker book? [1]

A Saturday B Sunday C Monday

Answer: _____

6. Why did the speaker volunteer? [1]

A To sell tickets B To meet a writer C To practise talking to strangers

Answer: _____

7. Which jacket did the speaker finally choose? [1]

A Blue B Green C Red

Answer: _____

8. What was the speaker's main difficulty? [1]

A Judging the size online B Finding the shop C Deciding on a price

Answer: _____

Exercise 3 · Monologue and sentence completion

9. The new room is about ... [1]

A energy B medicine C transport

Answer: _____

10. On Sundays the room opens at ... [1]

A nine B ten C eleven

Answer: _____

11. The most popular activity is making ... [1]

A a model boat B a paper windmill C a solar lamp

Answer: _____

12. Borrowed equipment must go back to ... [1]

A the desk B the café C the website

Answer: _____

Exercise 4 · Multiple matching

Match Speakers 1–4 to the statement that best describes each person. Two statements are unused. [4]

A The schedule changed to make attendance possible.

B Joining helped build friendships with local people.

C The speaker wants to lead the group.

D The group was less expensive than expected.

E Advice helped the speaker improve their pace.

F The speaker dislikes outdoor exercise.

Speaker 1: _____ [1]

Speaker 2: _____ [1]

Speaker 3: _____ [1]

Speaker 4: _____ [1]

Exercise 5 · Interview

17. What was Maya's original aim? [1]

A To repair every object B To learn practical skills C To earn money from repairs

Answer: _____

18. What problem did the caretaker help solve? [1]

A Finding safe storage B Ordering more headphones C Making a website

Answer: _____

19. What surprised Maya about the students? [1]

A They were often late B They wanted to learn how repairs worked C They brought no broken items

Answer: _____

20. What does Maya plan for next term? [1]

A Daily sessions B A monthly visit from an experienced volunteer C Moving to another school

Answer: _____

Answers and teacher scripts

Answers: 1 B, 2 D, 3 C, 4 A; 5 A, 6 C, 7 B, 8 A; 9 A, 10 B, 11 B, 12 A; Speakers 1 B, 2 E, 3 A, 4 D; 17 B, 18 A, 19 B, 20 B. Each answer earns one mark.

How the distractors work

Several scripts mention a plan before changing it. Follow “but”, “instead” and “in fact”; in matching, two statements are deliberately unused. Replay or re-read only after recording the first answer.

Exercise 1 · four extracts

1. I was going to travel by train, but there were no services after five. My father offered to drive me; unfortunately, the car would not start. Luckily I still had my bicycle, so I arrived on time.
2. My appointment used to be on Friday at ten, but I will be away then. The office offered Saturday at half past ten, which suits me perfectly.
3. You do not need your laptop for the drawing workshop, and the organiser will provide paper. Bring a notebook to record the tips you want to remember.
4. Meet me outside the library. The museum is next door, but it does not open until later, so we can leave our bags at the library first.

Exercise 2 · two extracts

Extract A. The book fair is open on Saturday and Sunday, but Sunday tickets have sold out. I booked Saturday morning instead. I volunteered at the entrance last year because I wanted to practise talking to people I had not met.

Extract B. I ordered a blue jacket online, but it did not fit. The shop had no smaller one in blue, so I chose the green version. I would have bought it in person if I had known how difficult the sizes were to judge.

Exercise 3 · monologue

Welcome to the Riverside Science Centre. This month our new room is about energy in everyday life. The room opens at nine on weekdays and at ten on Sundays. You can test small solar lamps at the first table. The most popular activity so far has been building a paper windmill and changing its blades to see what happens. Our guides can help younger visitors, but older students should try the instructions first. The café closes at four, an hour before the building. Please return any borrowed equipment to the desk before you leave. Next month we plan a short workshop for families, and details will appear on our website.

Exercise 4 · four speakers

Speaker 1. I joined the running group to meet people, and now I recognise neighbours all along the route. The distance matters less to me than the conversation.

Speaker 2. My first attempt was too fast. The coach taught me to begin slowly, and after a month I could complete the route without stopping.

Speaker 3. I enjoy running, but I cannot come on weekdays. I asked for a Saturday meeting and was pleased when the organiser agreed.

Speaker 4. I expected the group to buy expensive equipment. In fact, my comfortable old shoes were fine, so joining cost me almost nothing.

Exercise 5 · interview

Interviewer: Why did you start the after-school repair group? Maya: Several students had broken bags and headphones. We could not repair everything, but I wanted us to learn useful skills. Interviewer: What was the first difficulty? Maya: We had tools, but no safe place to store them; the caretaker helped us find a locked cupboard. Interviewer: Has anything surprised you? Maya: Yes. I thought students would rush to get things fixed. Instead, many stay to watch and ask how a repair works. Interviewer: What will change next term? Maya: We will keep the group small and invite an experienced volunteer once a month to teach us about safety. I would rather improve what we already do than promise a session every day.

Teacher delivery

Read every extract twice with a natural short pause. Do not emphasise the correct option. Check the full official Cambridge regulations before administering an actual exam; this script is for classroom practice only.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.